# 2015 Chevrolet Cruze

$5,000 · 143,057 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

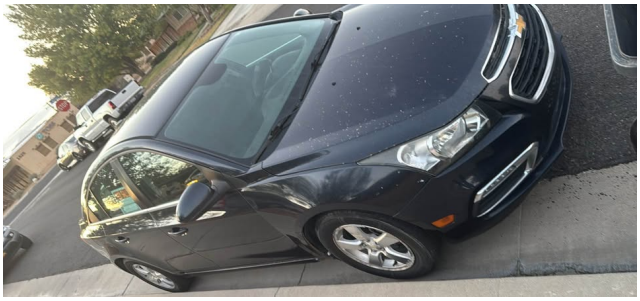
Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1802364164125848/

Report generated October 26, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder







+ 1 more photos in the app.

| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$5,683** | **$514** | **Below average** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 2/5 · 4 recalls · 252 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $5,000.00 |
| Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV | $462.50 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $32.50 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $65.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $5,683.00 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $5,000.00 |
| Amount financed | $683.00 |
| Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR) | $13.69 |
| Total interest over the loan | $138.16 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,150.00 |

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $13.69 |
| Insurance (estimate, full) | $135.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 28 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $169.64 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $180.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $15.21 |
| Total per month | $513.54 |

Running costs without the loan: **$500/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$11,878** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Below average (2/5)**

Below average. 1st-gen Cruze has a weak cooling system and oil leaks, especially the 1.4L turbo. 252 owner complaints, 99 about the engine. Risky in desert heat.

NHTSA data for this model year: 4 recalls · 252 owner complaints (20 involving a crash). Most complaints: Engine (99), Electrical System (49), Unknown Or Other (46), Power Train (37), Electronic Stability Control (Esc) (30), Steering (24).

**Known issues for this model**

• 1.4T: coolant leaks (water pump, thermostat housing, coolant tank) - plastic parts crack

• 1.4T: PCV valve in valve cover fails -> oil leaks, whistling, rough idle

• Oil cooler line / turbo oil feed leaks

• Overheating

• 6-speed automatic harsh shifts / failure at high miles

• Recalls: parking brake bracket, seat belt bolt, steering (build-date specific)

**Check on this car before buying**

• Which engine? 1.8L (LS) is the safer one

• Look for dried coolant crust, sweet smell, low reservoir

• Watch temp gauge on a hill / long idle

• Ask what cooling parts have been replaced

• Pre-purchase inspection

## Notes

$5,000 OBO. Automatic, blue/black, gasoline. Paid off, 2 owners, 'good condition'. Listed ~Oct 12. Seller got a different car.

No smog mentioned - seller must provide a smog cert (< 90 days).

Trim unknown: LS = 1.8L (simpler); 1LT/2LT/LTZ/Eco = 1.4L turbo (coolant leaks, PCV/valve cover, oil leaks, overheating). Ask which engine.

Ask: cooling system repairs (water pump, thermostat housing, coolant reservoir), any overheating, transmission service.

TODO: get VIN.

RECALLS (model-level, depend on build date - confirm by VIN): parking brake cable bracket (15V-113, Feb 2015 builds); driver seat belt bolt (15V-876); steering (15V-442). Likely already fixed on a 10-yr-old car - check via VIN.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.